

KEY

Verreaux's sifaka
Red-tailed sportive lemur

Fat-tailed dwarf lemur
Ring-tailed lemur
Aye-aye

Lemurs in danger

Each species of lemur is adapted to live in a different type of forest habitat, from the ring-tailed lemur in the dry forests of the south to the rainforest-dependent aye-aye. Because many lemurs are restricted to tiny areas of habitat, they are increasingly vulnerable to threats such as deforestation.

INDIAN
OCEAN

MADAGASCAR

Aye-aye

This nocturnal lemur can be found in the rainforests of eastern Madagascar. Despite being rare wherever it occurs, the aye-aye could be one of the widest-ranging lemur species.

Wet nose

Lemurs have forward-facing eyes like related monkeys, but differ from monkeys in having a more pointed, wet nose—good for sniffing scents, especially at night.

Hunting for woodworm

The aye-aye is a highly specialized feeder. It preys on invertebrates, such as fleshy wood-boring grubs, which live inside tree branches. By tapping a branch and listening to the echo, it can detect if a grub is inside. It gnaws a hole in the wood and hooks the grub out with a specially adapted spindly finger.



WEIGHING ONLY 1 OZ (31 G), MADAME BERTHE'S MOUSE LEMUR IS THE SMALLEST PRIMATE IN THE WORLD

Tail flag

The long, striped tail of a ring-tailed lemur is a visual signal. When traveling in their group, lemurs wave their tails like a flag to help keep members together.



Ring-tailed lemur